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From:  Miriam Halloran <m.halloran@westbrook.example.edu>
To:  Lena Marchetti; Tomás Ferreira; Hana Oduya
Date:  Fri, 3 Jul 2026, 11:47 PM
Subject:  Re:  June results memo + intro draft -- my comments
Attachments:  (none)
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Hi all,

As promised on Tuesday, here are my comments on Hana's June memo and Lena's intro v1. Overall: this is a promising project and the design is better than most of what I see at this stage. But several things need to happen before the brown bag, and some before anything leaves the building. Numbered so you can reply point by point.

1. Block fixed effects. I said this on Tuesday and I'll say it again. The lottery is random *within* blocks, not across them. Any regression without block FE is partly comparing students who chose suite-style areas with students who chose traditional halls, and that choice is not random. Hana, if IR is stuck, go to the Housing Office directly. Their lottery software must store the block IDs. This is the single most important thing.

2. Show me that it's friendship. Before you present this anywhere, including the brown bag, I want to see the first stage estimated with the *senior-survey friend nominations*, not only the co-swipe ties. If the effect exists only in the swipe data, I am not convinced you are measuring friendship rather than who eats in the same dining hall. Even an imprecise estimate with the survey measure would help. If the IRB question is what's holding this up, sort it out this week.

3. The Chetty framing in the intro. Lena, the intro says Chetty et al. (2022) show that high-EC counties *cause* a 20 percent increase in income. They do not say that. It's a descriptive counterfactual, and they are careful to call their results associations. Ironically, that is exactly the gap your paper could fill, so say it that way. A seminar audience full of economists will pounce on the current sentence.

4. Consent and the earnings sample. Hana's memo says UI consent comes from the senior exit survey. If so, the earnings sample is conditioned on persistence to senior year, which is itself plausibly affected by treatment. You need bounds, and you need to show treatment effects on persistence and on consent. If there is any chance consent was collected earlier, find out. It changes the whole discussion.

5. Multiple outcomes. Decide your primary outcomes before you run the rest. Write them down and date the document. Consider an index.

6. Scope and external validity. One flagship. Be modest in the intro and especially in the policy paragraph. And if you want to talk about SES-balanced housing as policy, you have to tell me what happens to the *high*-SES students. Nobody on a housing committee will adopt this without knowing.

7. Smaller things. (a) Michelman, Price & Zimmerman found essentially no benefit for public-school students at Harvard. You need a paragraph on why your setting differs. (b) The memo reports EC means above 1. Please make sure the definition matches what we'll use in the paper. (c) I'd drop Jácome et al. unless you have a reason.

8. Status memo. Please send me a **one-page status memo by August 15**: what is done, what is not, and a realistic timeline to a full draft. I'm on leave the second half of August and want to read it before then.

Looking forward to the brown bag. Please reply to each point, even if the reply is "not yet".

Best,
Miriam

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